

Christopher You

PhD · Human-Centered Computing

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Summary

PhD in Human-Centered Computing with a research program at the intersection of applied AI systems, conversational agents, and human-AI collaboration in healthcare. First author of 7+ and co-author of 12+ peer-reviewed publications and across HCI and AI venues, leading development and analysis on several NIH-funded projects spanning psychiatric care, cancer clinical trials, and doctoral research on AI-mediated mental well-being. Experienced in mentoring undergraduate and graduate students to independent research and publication. Committed to advancing human-centered AI that is rigorously evaluated, broadly accessible, and designed to meaningfully improve real lives.

Education

Ph.D. in Human-Centered Computing
Aug 2020 - May 2026
University of Florida
GPA: 3.8
Advisor: Dr. Benjamin Lok
Dissertation: "A Change in Perspective: Exploring Interaction Paradigms in AI and Virtual Human Systems that Engage Users and Promote Mental Health"

M.S. in Computer Science
Aug 2020 - Dec 2022
University of Florida
GPA: 3.8
Advisor: Dr. Benjamin Lok

B.S. in Computer Science
Sep 2018 - May 2020
University of Minnesota
GPA: 3.8
Advisor: Dr. Evan Suma Rosenberg

Experience

Postdoctoral Fellow
Aug 2026 - Current
Johns Hopkins University

- Postdoctoral fellow in the **Center for Digital Health and Artificial Intelligence (CDHAI)**, a research-focused center that coordinates collaborations across academia, industry, government, and policy organizations to address healthcare challenges.

Research Assistant
Aug 2020 - May 2026
University of Florida

- Broad impacts of research: (1) embodied agents to improve care for psychiatric patients (**NIH R34 Grant**), (2) AI clinical trial enrollment platform for cancer patients (**NIH R24/U01 Grant**), (3) AI patient simulations in university curriculum, and (4) conversational AI and agentic systems to support mental well-being.
- Designed Build-a-Being Yourself, a web-based conversational AI research platform enabling domain experts to rapidly author and deploy agent-based interventions at scale across multiple active studies.
- Developed and evaluated a multi-institutional AI Clinical Trial Enrollment Platform (Beta Link), conducting user studies with 1500+ patients and building evaluation pipelines analyzing model outputs, engagement metrics, and behavioral outcomes.
- Investigated human-AI collaboration through 10+ web-deployed user studies, integrating user-state modeling, retrieval-augmented generation, LLM fine-tuning, and VR technologies into experimental research protocols.
- Mentored undergraduate and graduate students in research methods, system development, and academic writing, directly advising 3 undergraduates to peer-reviewed publication.

Teaching Assistant
Jan 2024 - May 2024

University of Florida

- Designed coursework and projects for CEN4722: User Experience Design, including a semester-long capstone in which 25 student teams conducted user interviews with campus organizations and peers to identify pain points and prototype meaningful application solutions.
- Curated weekly readings to reinforce course objectives and develop critical thinking around human-centered design principles.
- Collaborated with faculty to plan lectures and course activities, held regular office hours, and provided feedback to support 100 students across all stages of the design process.

Research Assistant
May 2022 - Aug 2022

Davidson College

- Conducted in-depth research on embodiment and agency in avatars within VR and desktop environments, leading to two publications.
- Built IK-driven avatar systems to achieve high-fidelity user embodiment using consumer VR tracking.

Software Engineering Intern
May 2020 - Aug 2020

Amazon

- Architected knowledge graph-backed query system spanning Amazon Help Services and Alexa, enabling semantic search across large-scale service documentation.
- Designed and implemented full-stack SPARQL query interface, integrating NLP-driven entity resolution with a structured graph backend.
- Built frontend and API layer to expose graph query results to end users at production scale.

Research Assistant
Oct 2018 - May 2020

University of Minnesota

- Created novel redirection techniques for locomotion in VR, leading to two publications.
- Developed programming skills in C# using Unity to explore practical applications of VR systems.

Publications

Journal Proceedings

[5] **You, C.,** Ghosh, R., Vilaro, M., Venkatakrishnan, R., Venkatakrishnan, R., Maxim, A., Peng, X., Tamboli, D., & Lok, B. (2025). Alter egos alter engagement: Perspective-taking can improve disclosure quantity and depth to AI chatbots in promoting mental wellbeing. *Frontiers in Digital Health*, *7*, 1655860

[4] **You, C.,** Venkatakrishnan, R., Venkatakrishnan, R., Han, Z., Lok, B., & Peck, T. (2024). A sense of urgency on the sense of agency: Challenges in evaluating agency and embodiment in virtual reality. *IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics*

[3] **You, C.,** Peck, T., Stuart, J., Gomes de Siqueira, A., & Lok, B. (2024). What my bias meant for my embodiment: An investigation on virtual embodiment in desktop-based virtual reality. *Frontiers in Virtual Reality*, *5*, 1251564

[2] **You, C.,** Ghosh, R., Canales, R., Venkatakrishnan, R., Venkatakrishnan, R., Kauer, T., & Lok, B. (**In review**). Social perspective-taking and human-AI collaboration can promote change talk and readiness in agent-delivered motivational interviews [Preprint available on SSRN]. *Computers in Human Behavior*

[1] **You, C.,** Ghosh, R., Kauer, T., Franco, C., Canales, R., Krieger, J., & Lok, B. (**In preparation**). Applying positive-unlabeled learning for fraudulent data detection in online clinical trial recruitment. *Journal of the American Medical Informatics Association*

Conference Proceedings

[7] Tamboli, D. N. A., Canales, R., **You, C.,** Reese, P., Potluri, V., & Lok, B. (2026). Experiential knowledge in multi-agent virtual health systems: The value of an expert patient agent. *Proceedings of the 26th ACM International Conference on Intelligent Virtual Agents*, 1–10

[6] **You, C.,** Ghosh, R., Maxim, A., Peng, X., Tamboli, D., Huang, Z., Venkatakrishnan, R., & Lok, B. (2026). Build-A-Being Yourself: A web-based system for authoring embodied conversational agents in healthcare research. *International Conference on Human-Computer Interaction*, 427–446

[5] Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Venkatakrishnan, R., & Lok, B. (2025). The impact of health literacy in a virtual agent intervention addressing barriers to cancer clinical trial participation. *Proceedings of the 13th International Conference on Human-Agent Interaction*, 76–86

[4] Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Venkatakrishnan, R., & Lok, B. (2025). Exploring the influence of multiple virtual agents for addressing barriers to cancer clinical trial participation. *Proceedings of the 25th ACM International Conference on Intelligent Virtual Agents*, 1–10

[3] **You, C.,** Benda, B., Rosenberg, E. S., Ragan, E., Lok, B., & Thomas, J. (2022). Strafing gain: Redirecting users one diagonal step at a time. *2022 IEEE International Symposium on Mixed and Augmented Reality (ISMAR)*, 603–611

[2] **You, C.,** Ghosh, R., Maxim, A., Stuart, J., Cooks, E., & Lok, B. (2022). How does a virtual human earn your trust? Guidelines to improve willingness to self-disclose to intelligent virtual agents. *Proceedings of the 22nd ACM International Conference on Intelligent Virtual Agents*, 1–8

[1] Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Canales, R., Venkatakrishnan, R., & Lok, B. (**In submission**). Embodying support: Investigating multiple embodied virtual agents on engagement and behavioral outcomes in health information seeking. *Proceedings of the 26th ACM International Conference on Intelligent Virtual Agents*, 1–10

Posters, Abstracts, & Demos

[12] Wang, F., Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Kauer, T., Maxim, A. H., Franco, C., Anton, S., Flood-Grady, E., Gaillard, T., George, T. J., Lok, B., Tucker, C., Vilaro, M., Lin, T., Webb, F., Wilkie, D., Wilson-Howard, D., Carrasquillo, O., & Krieger, J. L. (2026). Can artificial intelligence amplify community voice? Evidence from a multisite formative evaluation of the AI-powered ALEX portal to enhance equity in clinical trial access. *19th AACR Conference on The Science of Cancer Health Disparities*, 1

[11] Kauer, T., Franco, C., Munroe, D., Flood-Grady, E., Gaillard, T., George, T., Lin, T., Lok, B., Tucker, C., Vilaro, M., Webb, F., Wilke, D., Wilson-Howard, D., Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Serat, J., Buhr, M., Murphy, C., van Mossel, A., … Krieger, J. (2025). Representation matters: The feasibility and impact of photo-realistic and social identity-matched virtual community health educators among Black, Hispanic, and Rural Adults. *Science of Community Outreach and Engagement Annual Conference*, 1

[10] Huynh, L., **You, C.,** Mazorra, G., Black, E., Lok, B., & Blue, A. (2025). A patient chatbot to support interprofessional learning [Oral presentation]. *Collaborating Across Borders IX*, 1

[9] Munroe, D., Kauer, T., Franco, C., Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Ford, H., Lok, B., & Krieger, J. L. (2025). Connecting communities: Developing a provider portal to enhance cancer trial diversity. *Science of Communication Outreach and Engagement Annual Conference*, 1

[8] Kauer, T., Franco, C., Lok, B., Tucker, C., Lin, T., Flood-Grady, E., Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Wilson-Howard, D., Gaillard, T., Anton, S., & Krieger, J. (2025). Connecting older adults to clinical trials: Developing the ALEX clinical trial referral portal. *14th Annual Alliance Meeting for Healthy Aging Conference*, 1

[7] Kauer, T., Franco, C., Munroe, D., Flood-Grady, E., Gaillard, T., Lin, T., Lok, B., Tucker, C., Wilson-Howard, D., Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Serat, J., Buhr, M., Wynter, S., Anton, S., & Krieger, J. (2025). A strengths- and community-based approach to increasing medical research participation among Black, Hispanic, and White rural populations in Florida [Poster Presentation]. *Mayo Clinic Transforming Community and Rural Healthcare 2025 Conference, Rochester, MN*, 1

[6] Ghosh, R., Maxim, A., **You, C.,** & Lok, B. (2024). Real-time virtual human for promoting clinical trial education and recruitment. *2024 IEEE Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces Abstracts and Workshops (VRW)*, 1184–1185

[5] Jurczyk, K., **You, C.,** Nourani, M., Gupta, M., Anthony, L., & Lok, B. (2021). Romadoro: Leveraging nudge techniques to encourage break-taking. *Adjunct Proceedings of the 34th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology*, 66–69

[4] **You, C.,** Suma Rosenberg, E., & Thomas, J. (2019). Strafing gain: A novel redirected walking technique. *Symposium on Spatial User Interaction*, 1–1

[3] Wang, F., Maxim, A. H., Franco, C., Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Kauer, T., Anton, S., Flood-Grady, E., Gaillard, T., George, T. J., Lok, B., Tucker, C., Vilaro, M., Lin, T., Webb, F., Wilkie, D., Wilson-Howard, D., Carrasquillo, O., & Krieger, J. L. (**In review**). Information that sparks dialogue: Supporting clinical trial communication through an AI-enabled portal. *American Psychosocial Oncology Society (APOS) 24th Annual Conference*

[2] Wang, F., Maxim, A. H., Franco, C., Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Kauer, T., Anton, S., Flood-Grady, E., Gaillard, T., George, T. J., Lok, B., Tucker, C., Vilaro, M., Lin, T., Webb, F., Wilkie, D., Wilson-Howard, D., Carrasquillo, O., & Krieger, J. L. (**In review**). Information that sparks dialogue: Supporting clinical trial communication through an AI-enabled portal. *2026 Mayo Research Fellows' Association Florida Research Day*

[1] Wang, F., Ghosh, R., **You, C.,** Kauer, T., Maxim, A. H., Franco, C., Anton, S., Flood-Grady, E., Gaillard, T., George, T. J., Lok, B., Tucker, C., Vilaro, M., Lin, T., Webb, F., Wilkie, D., Wilson-Howard, D., Carrasquillo, O., & Krieger, J. L. (**In submission**). Techquity through community-engaged AI design: A multisite formative evaluation of the ALEX portal for equitable cancer clinical trial access. *2026 Community Health Outcomes Research and Discovery Science Conference*, 1

Undergraduate-Mentored Articles

Undergraduate journal publications authored by students whom I directly mentored on a weekly basis throughout the project and manuscript development.

[2] Huynh, L., Blue, A., **You, C.,** Lok, B., Smith, G., Ghosh, R., & Venkatakrishnan, R. (2025). A feasibility study to assess virtual patients authenticity on building confidence in students' clinical decision-making. *UF Journal of Undergraduate Research*, *27*

[1] Smith, G., Huynh, L., **You, C.,** Ghosh, R., Venkatakrishnan, R., & Lok, B. (2025). Evaluating lip synchronization techniques in LLM-based virtual humans for healthcare and computer science applications. *UF Journal of Undergraduate Research*, *27*

Presentations and Invited Talks

Jan 2026	**Newspaper Interview**, When ChatGPT becomes a crisis helpline	*The Independent Alligator*
Mar 2025	**Guest Talk**, Embodied experiences to improve online virtual human mental health interventions	*Illusioneering Lab, UMN*
Oct 2024	**Conference**, A sense of urgency on the sense of agency: challenges in evaluating agency and embodiment in virtual reality.	*IEEE ISMAR*
Mar 2024	**Consortium**, Using the health belief model to tailor virtual humans for clinical trials	*IEEE VR*
Jun 2023	**Guest Lecture**, Strafing gain: Redirecting users one diagonal step at a time	*CEN4721 - HCI*
Oct 2022	**Conference**, Strafing gain: Redirecting users one diagonal step at a time	*IEEE ISMAR*
Sep 2022	**Conference**, How does a virtual human earn your trust? guidelines to improve willingness to self-disclose to intelligent virtual agents.	*ACM IVA*
Oct 2019	**Poster**, Strafing gain: A novel redirected walking technique	*ACM SUI*

Funding Received

2023 - 2026	**Generation NEXT Fellowship**, $10,000/yr	*University of Florida*
2024 - 2025	**L3Harris Graduate Scholarship**, $2,500	*University of Florida*
2021 - 2022	**Olson-Mitchell STEM Translational Communications Project Award**, $5,000	*University of Florida*
2020 - 2026	**Graduate School Preeminence Award**, $36,000/yr	*University of Florida*
2019 - 2020	**Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program Award**, $4,000	*University of Minnesota*

Services and Professional Activities

Mentoring

2022 - 2025	**Leyna Huynh**, Published article in Journal of Undergraduate Research	*University of Florida*
2022 - 2025	**Gaby Smith**, Published article in Journal of Undergraduate Research	*University of Florida*
2024 - 2025	**Lucas John**, Nutrition Module Project	*University of Florida*
2024 - 2025	**Abbhinav Sriram**, Build-a-Being Yourself Project	*University of Florida*
2022 - 2024	**Tarun Desari**, Presentation at Undergraduate Research Symposium	*University of Florida*
2022 - 2023	**Zhuoming Han**, Co-authored "A Sense of Urgency:..."	*University of Florida*

Student Volunteering

2024	**Paper Session**, International Symposium on Mixed and Augmented Reality	*IEEE ISMAR*
2024	**DEIA Accessibility Streaming**, Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces	*IEEE VR*
2019	**Paper Session**, Symposium on Spatial User Interaction	*ACM SUI*

Reviewing

2026	**Conference Reviewer**, International Symposium on Mixed and Augmented Reality	*IEEE ISMAR*
2024	**Conference Reviewer**, International Symposium on Mixed and Augmented Reality	*IEEE ISMAR*
2023	**Journal Reviewer**, International Journal of Human – Computer Studies	*IJHCS*
2022	**Conference Reviewer**, Conference on Virtual Reality and 3D User Interfaces	*IEEE VR*
2022	**Conference Reviewer**, International Symposium on Mixed and Augmented Reality	*IEEE ISMAR*